Controversy with civility section

Our group implemented different methods to discuss different opinions and resolve disagreements. Firstly, we encouraged equal participation between all the peers. All six members had the opportunity to share their ideas before the group made a big decision. Along with this method, active listening was implemented, allowing everyone to express their opinions without interruptions. One of the most important methods used was respectful communication. This meant that we focused on explaining our reasoning rather than criticising others. We did this by comparing advantages and disadvantages of all the ideas. If no agreement was reached after 15 minutes of discussion, we held a majority vote, ensuring everyone could contribute to the final decision.This therefore gave everyone the chance to be part of the final decision and feel part of the group.

Impact

Our methods worked well, and our end-of-week meeting allowed us to reflect on improvements. Everyone in the team was feeling comfortable expressing their opinion all week and no ideas were overlooked. However one of our weaknesses was spending 40 minutes debating the circuit design before reaching a compromise. Following our 15-minute discussion rule more strictly could have improved efficiency. The method of considering different perspectives helps us develop better solutions. Next time we could implement some new strategies such as introducing a one minute speaking turn would help to ensure equal participation. To conclude this experience improved my listening and teamwork skills, teaching me that every member's contribution is equally valuable to the team's success.